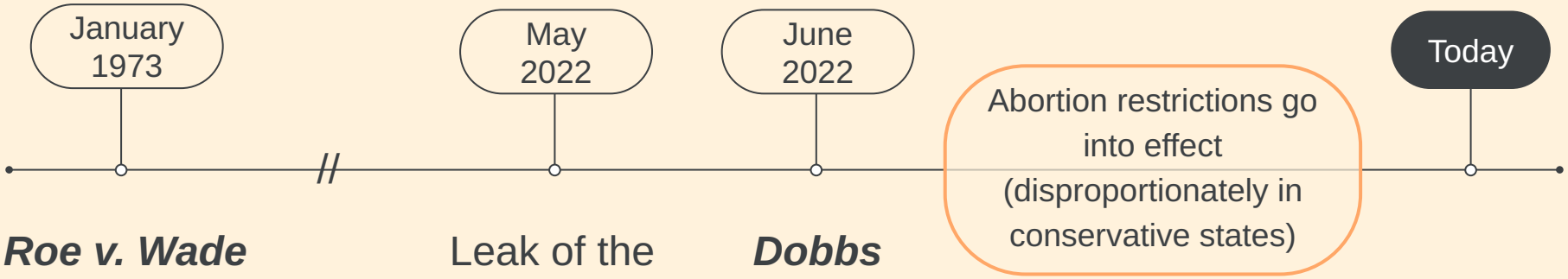
Red State, Blue State, Mental State

The Psychological Impact of *Dobbs v. Jackson* on Americans Across the Political Divide

Bradley Allen & Sam Parker

Supreme Reversal



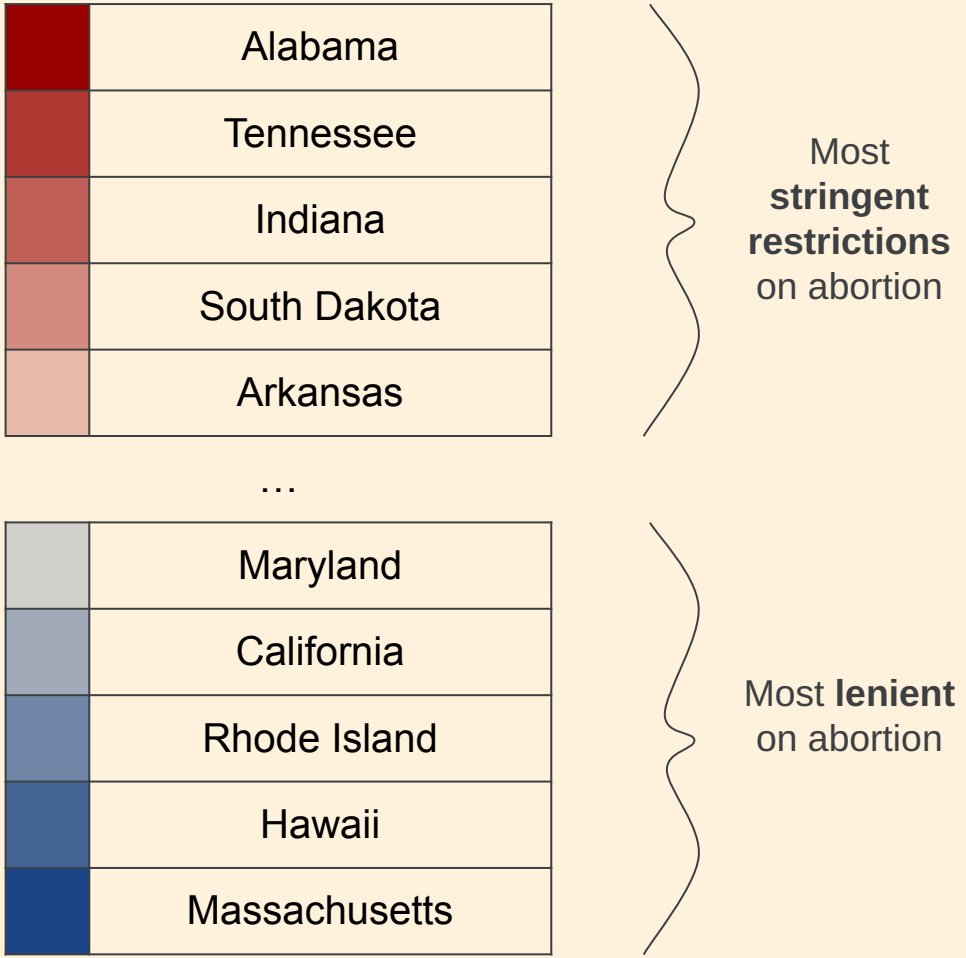
How did the *Dobbs v. Jackson* decision impact anxiety and depression scores in conservative vs. liberal states?

Other Significant Events

Table 1: Major U.S. Events 2022

Date	Event	Source
Feb. 24	Russia invades Ukraine	Latour and Crisp (2022)
May 2	Dobbs decision leaked	Gerstein (2022)
Jun. 24	Dobbs decision released	Latour and Crisp (2022)
Aug. 4	U.S. declares monkeypox emergency	Bullock et al. (n.d.)
Aug. 8	Mar-a-Lago Raid	Latour and Crisp (2022)
Oct.	Russia nuclear weapon rhetoric spike	Perplexity AI (2025a)
Nov. 9	Midterm Elections	Latour and Crisp (2022)

A ranking of state political leanings



THE HILL

Data

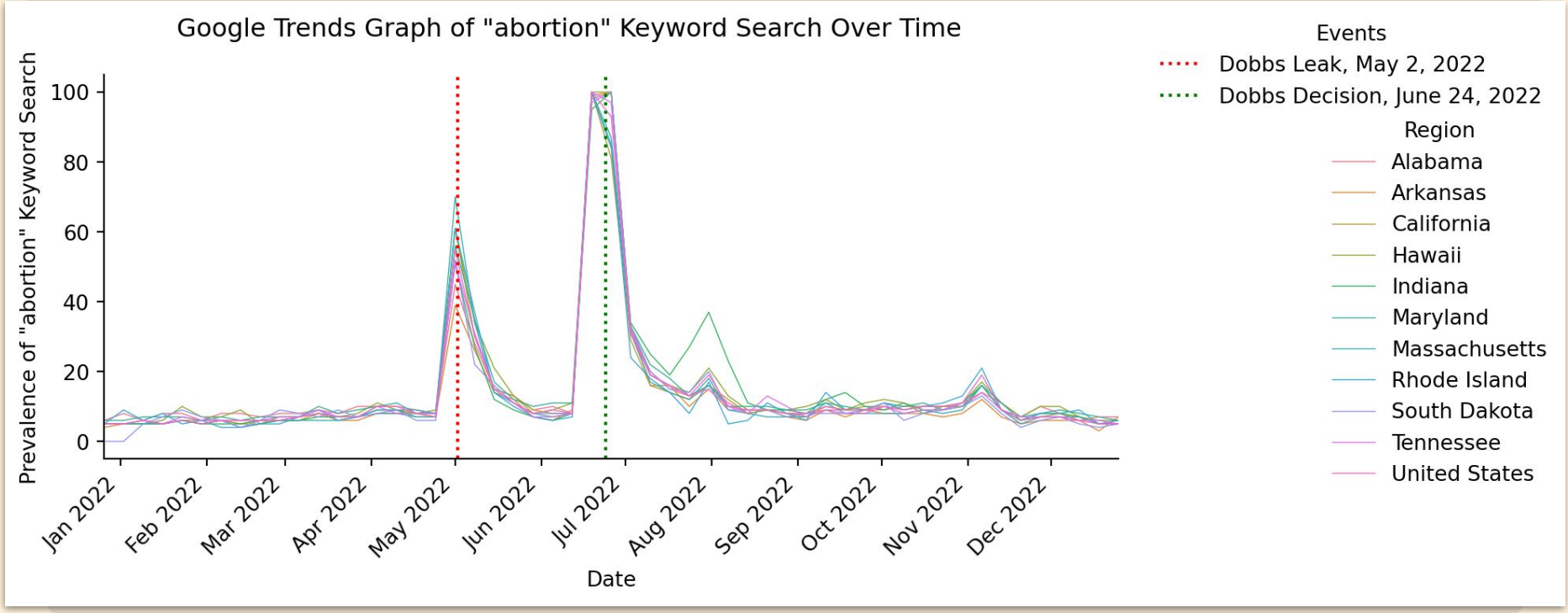
CDC Household Pulse Survey

Aggregated scores of anxiety and depression across various social groups, including by state of residence

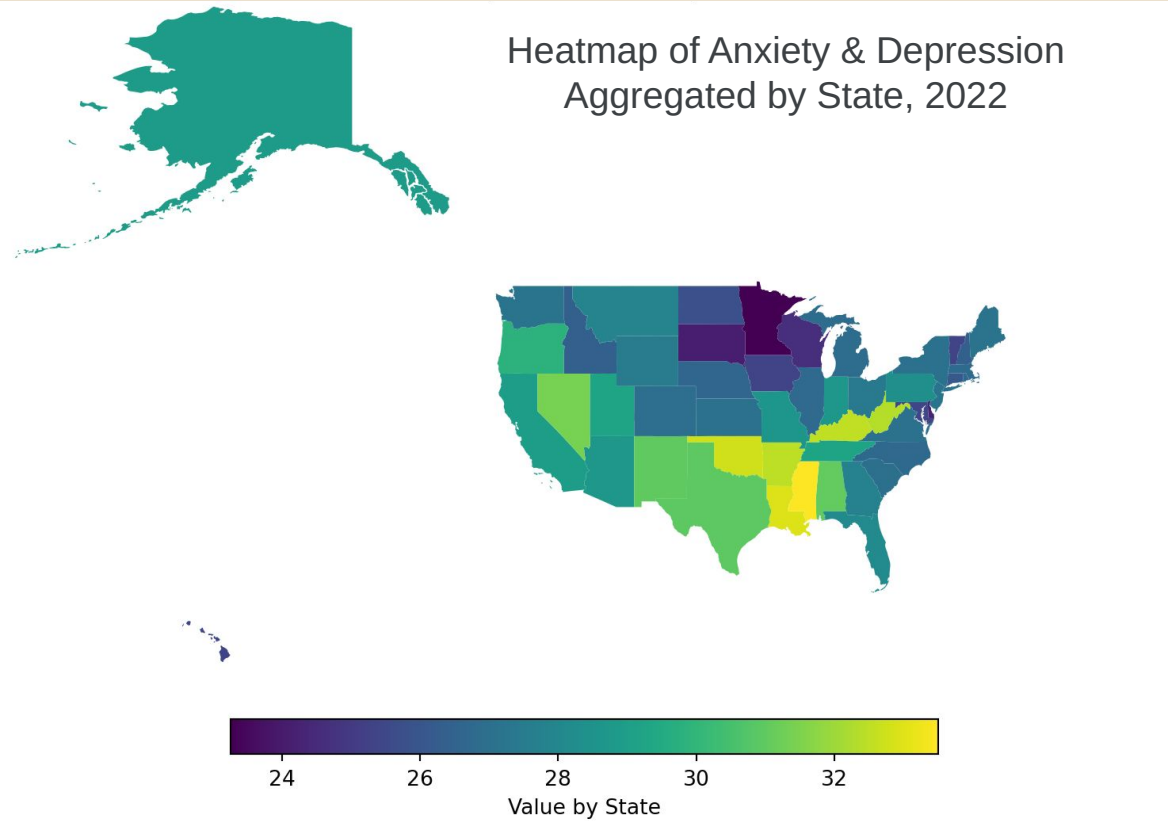
Google Trends

Interest over time in the keyword search term “abortion”

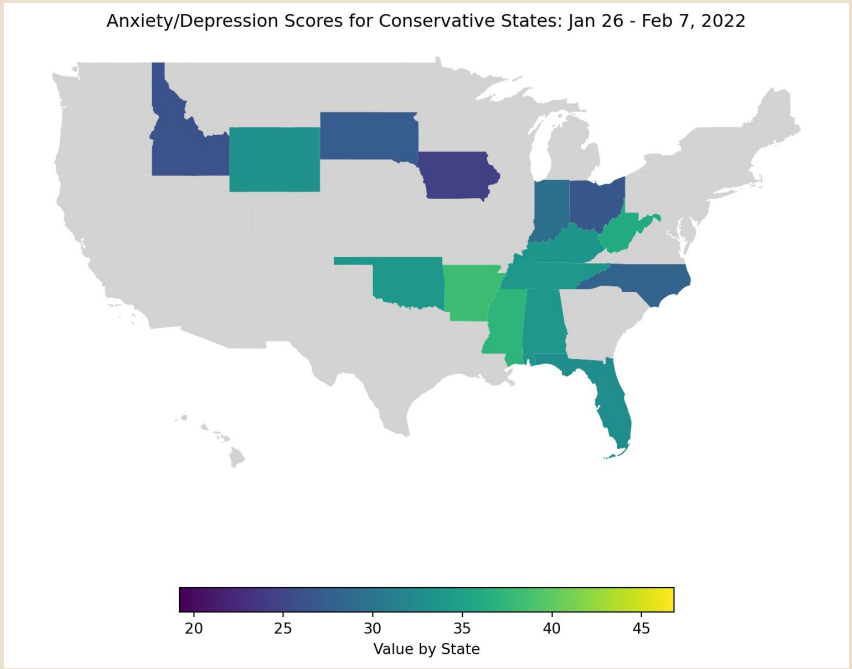
Google Trends Data

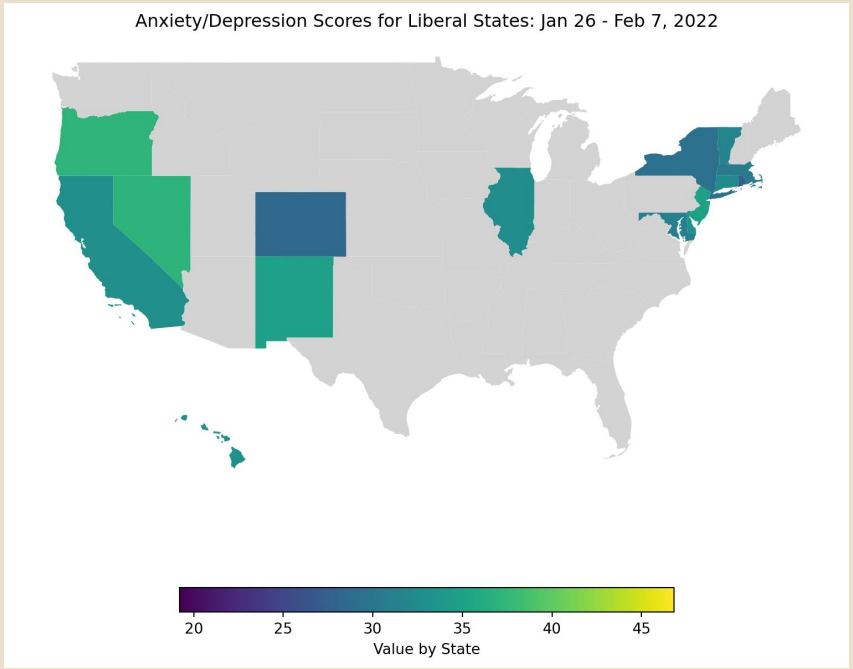


Anxiety & Depression, 2022



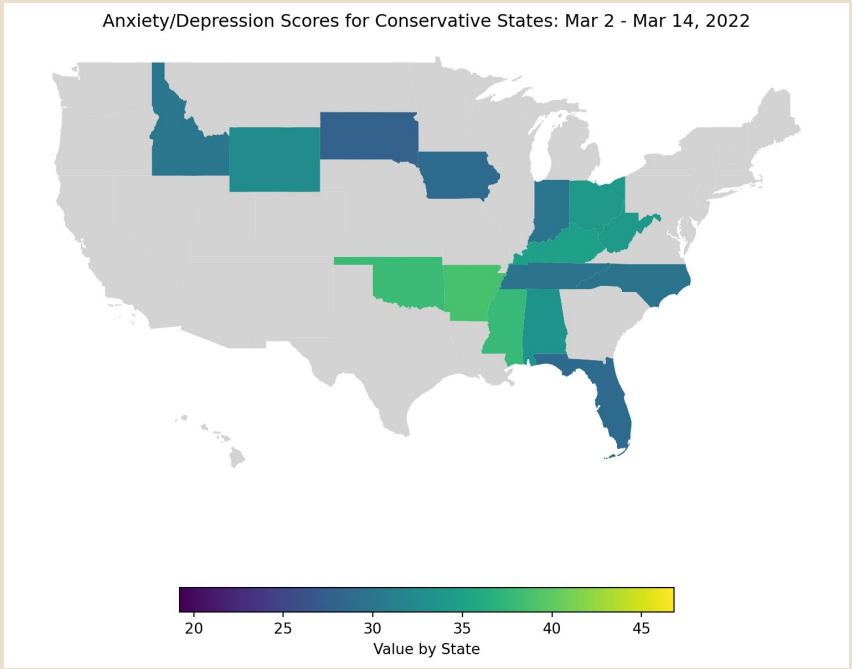
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

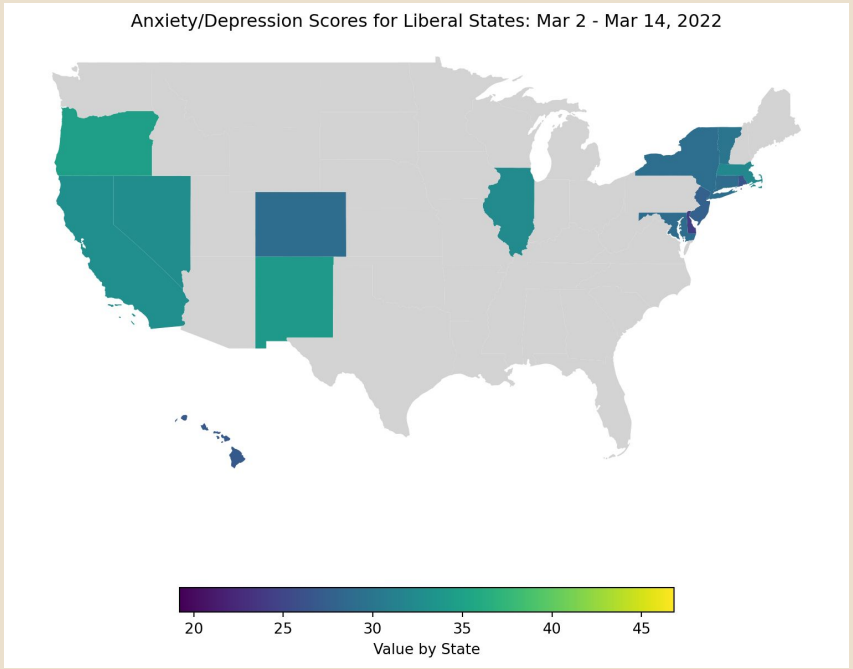




Jan 26 - Feb 7, 2022

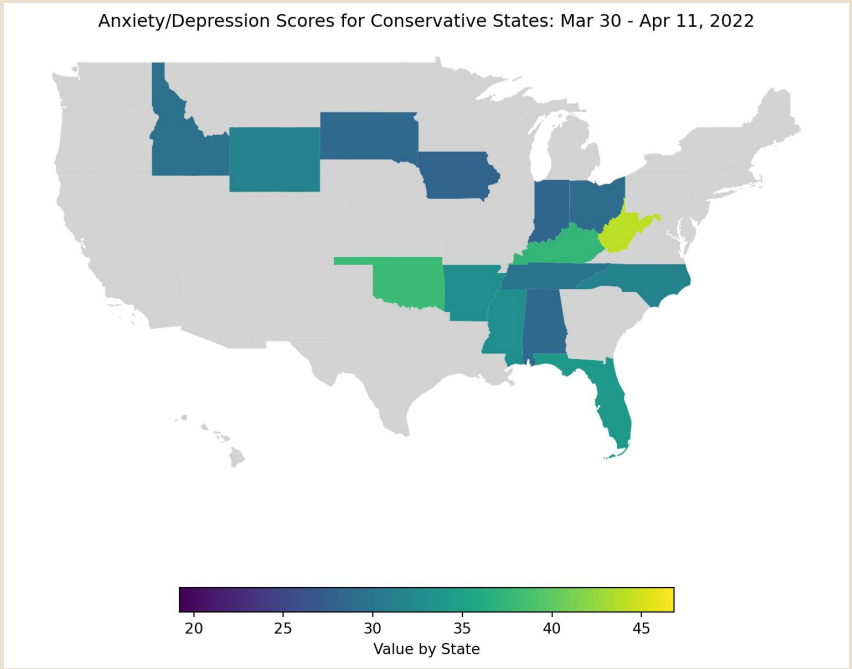
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

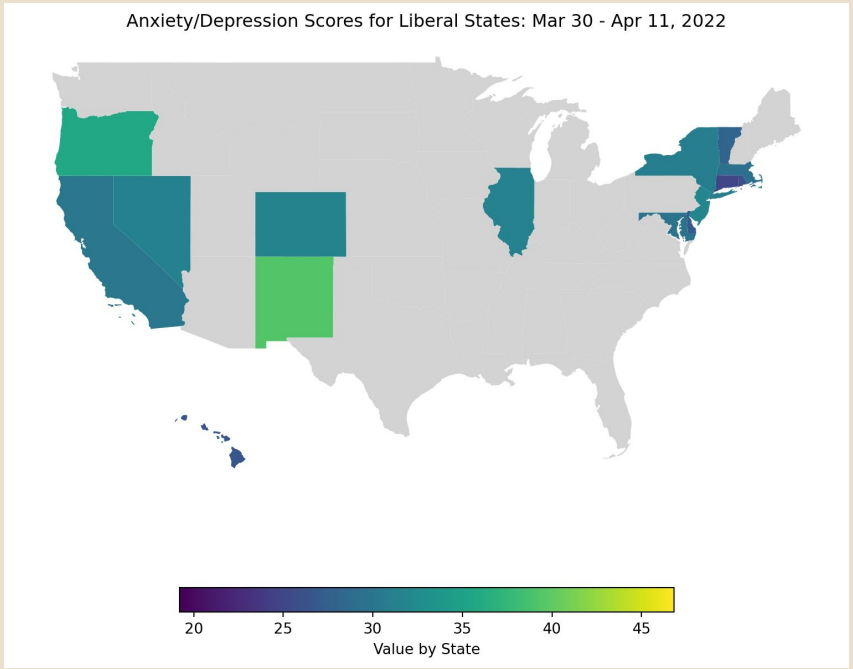




Mar 2 - Mar 14, 2022

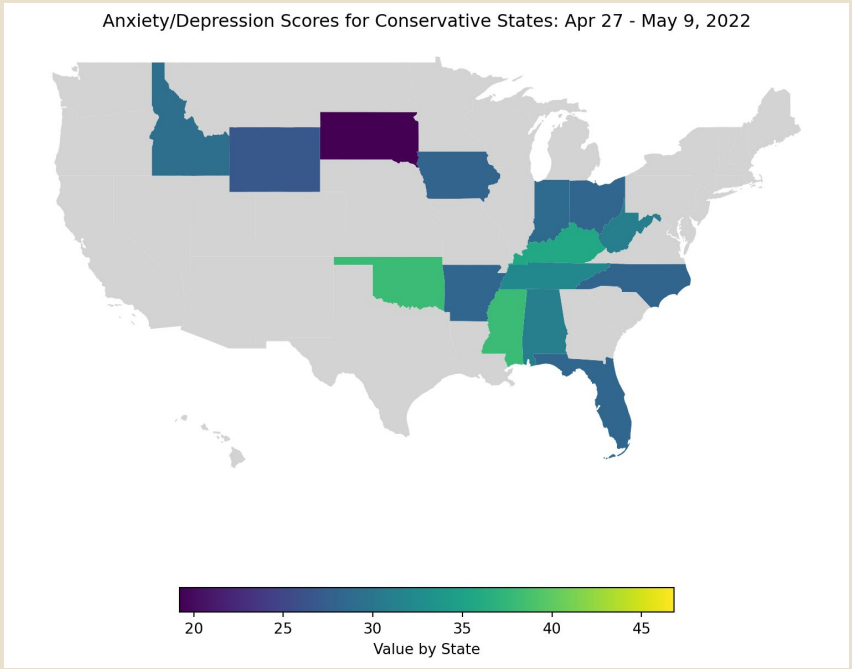
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

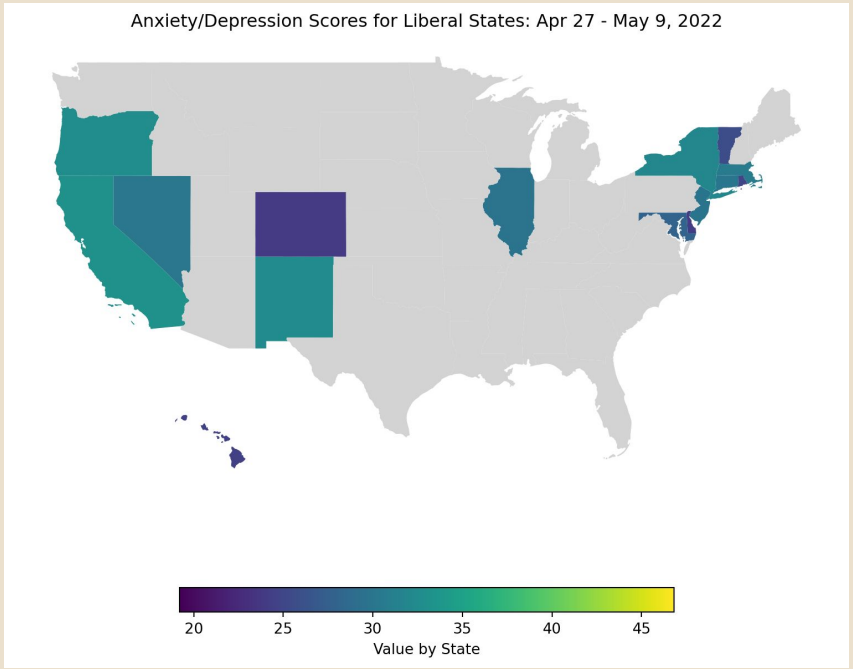




Mar 30 - Apr 11, 2022

Anxiety & Depression, 2022

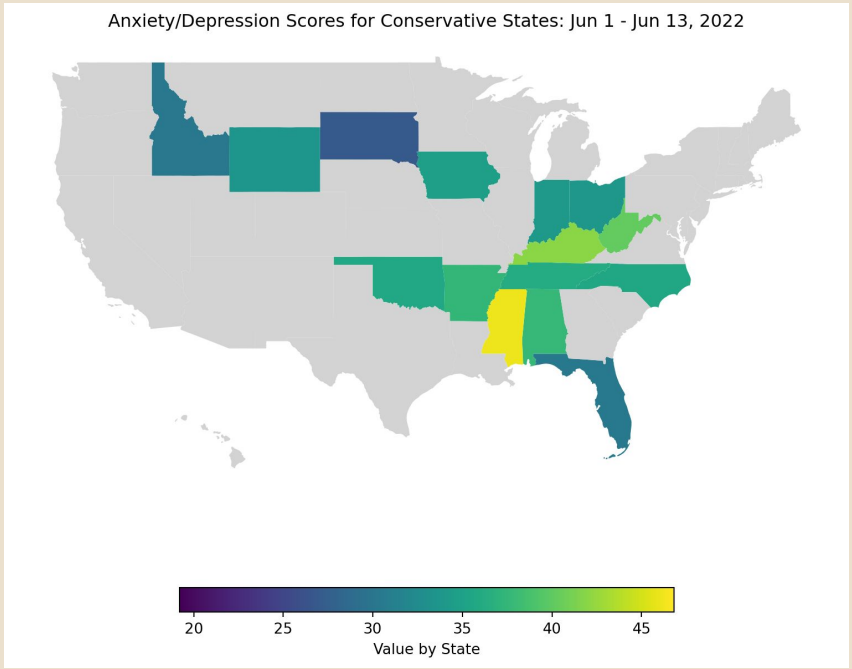


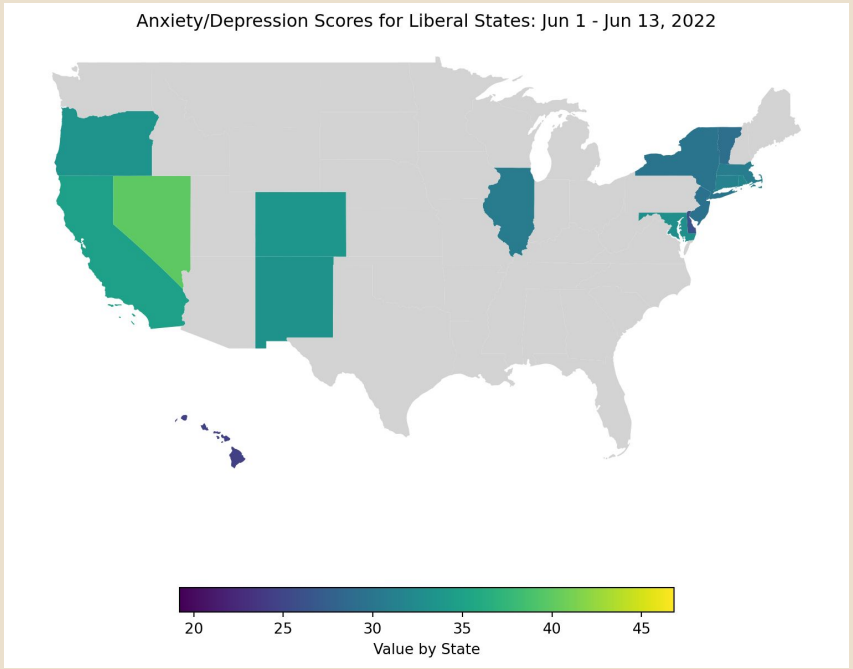


Apr 27 - May 9, 2022

Dobbs leak: May 2, 2022

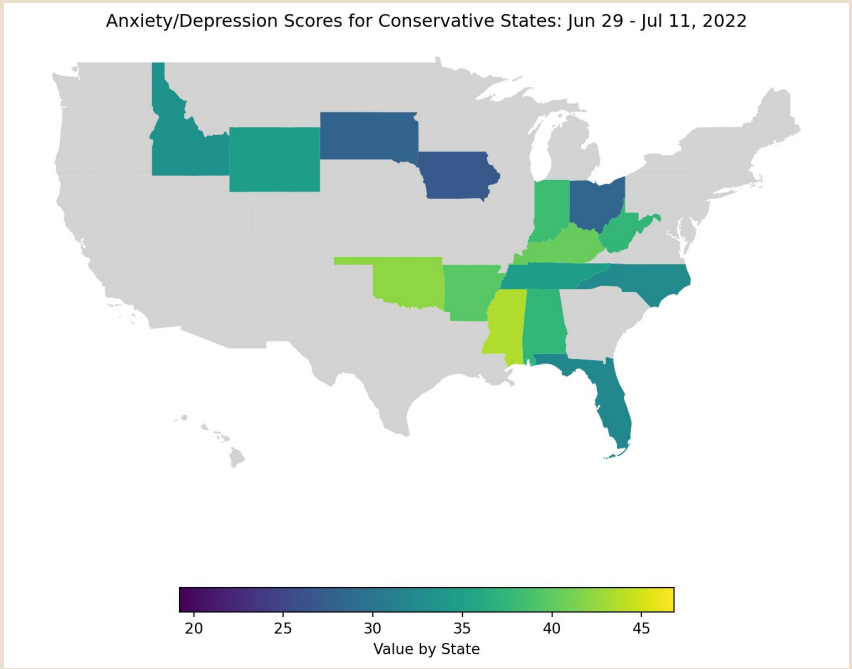
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

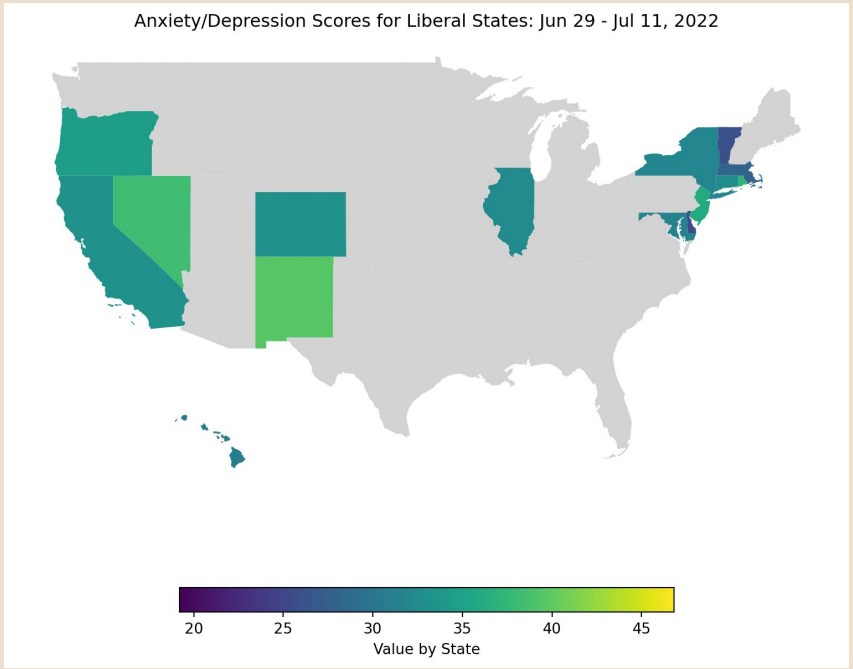




Jun 1 - Jun 13, 2022

Anxiety & Depression, 2022

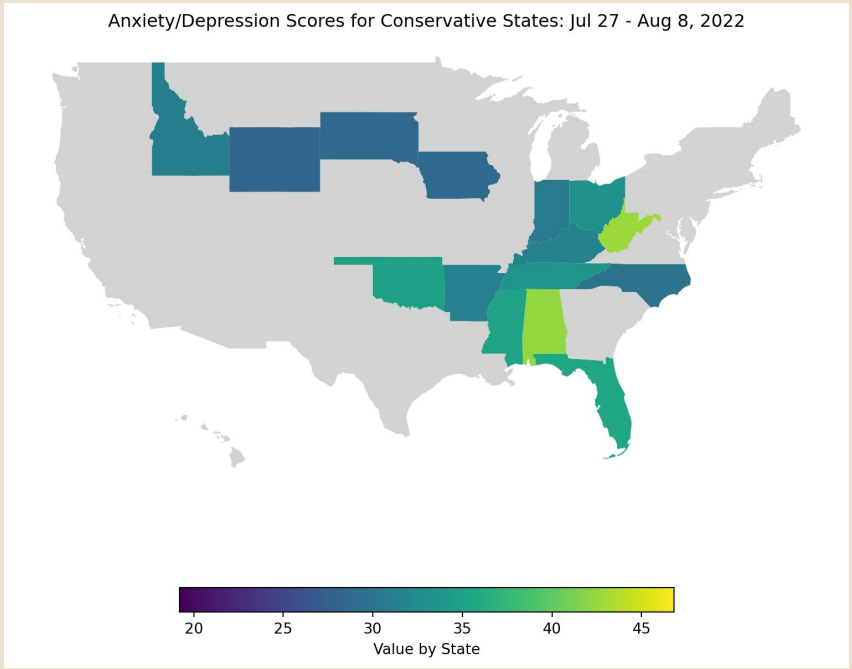


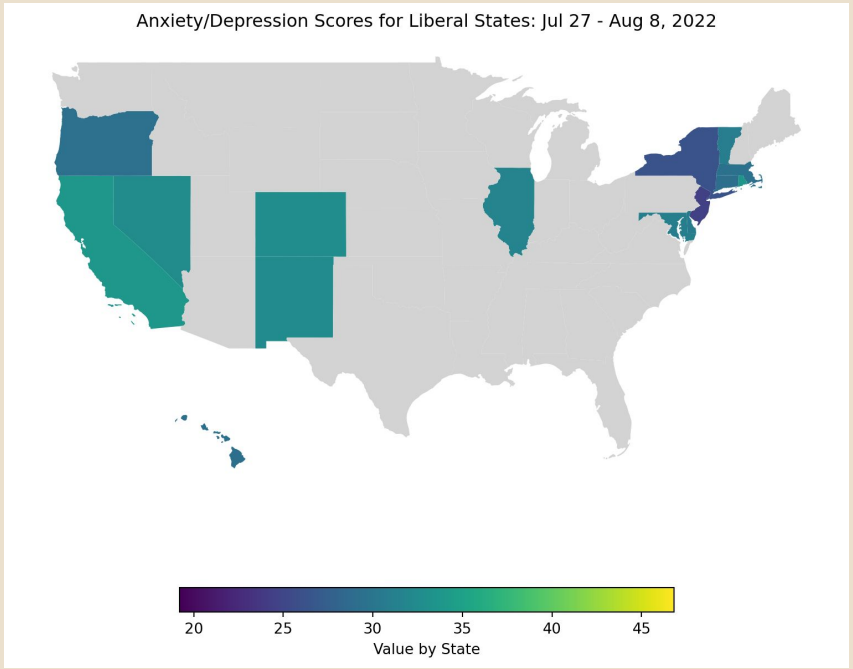


Jun 29 - Jul 11, 2022

Dobbs decision: June 24, 2022

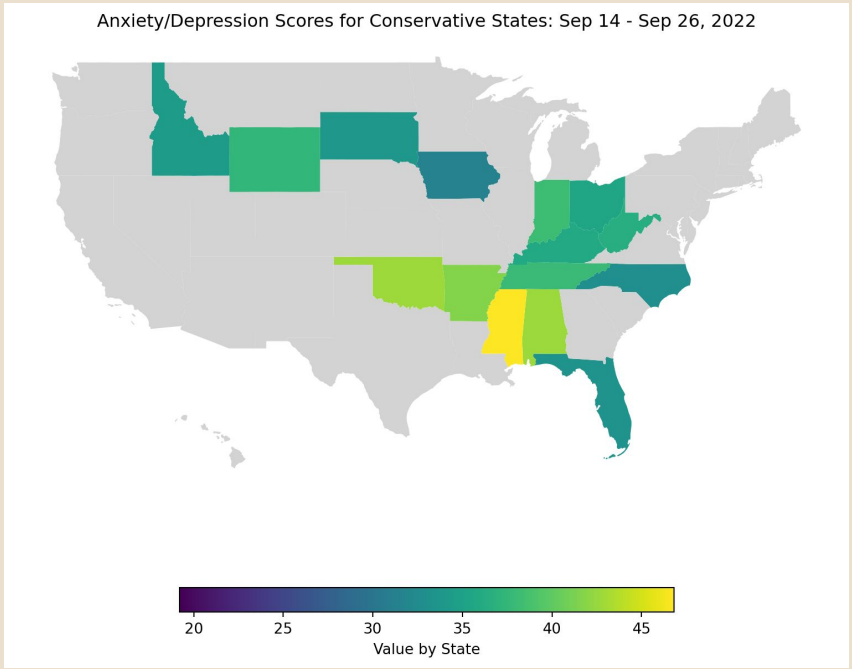
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

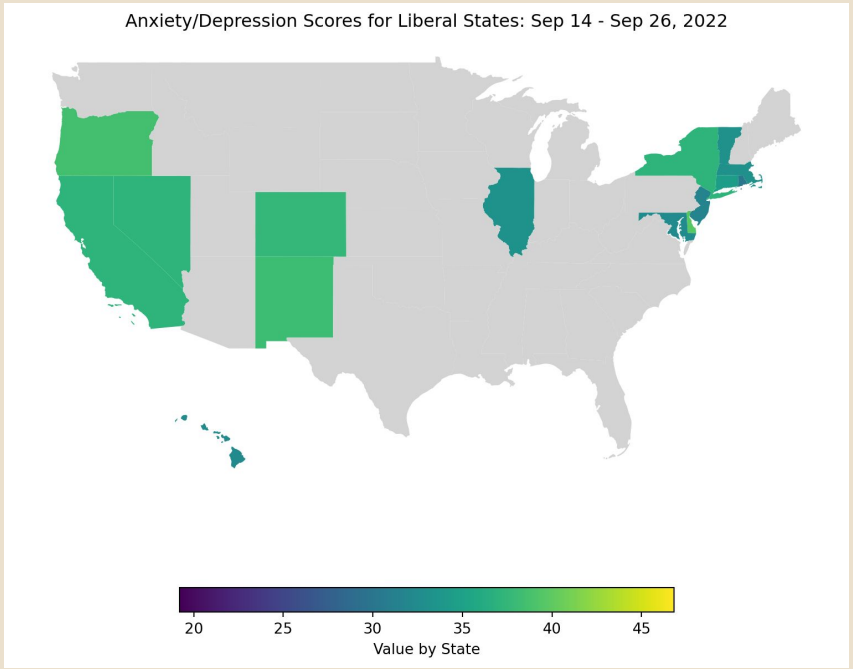




Jul 27 - Aug 8, 2022

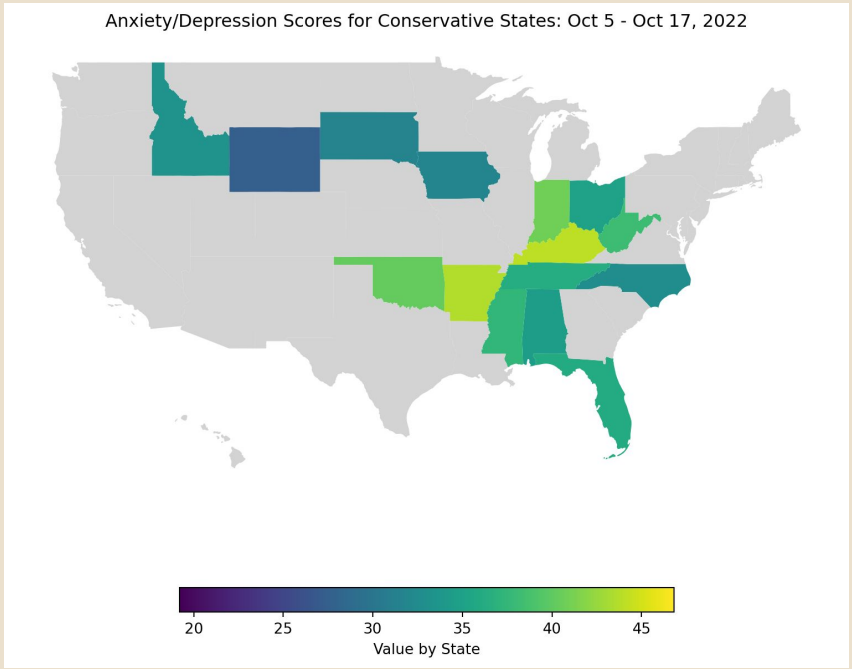
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

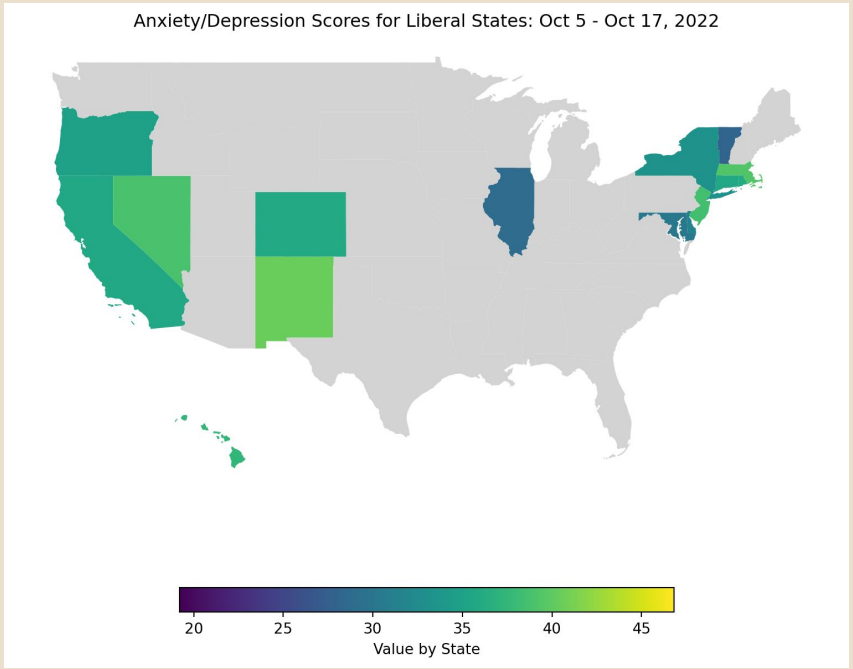




Sep 14 - Sep 26, 2022

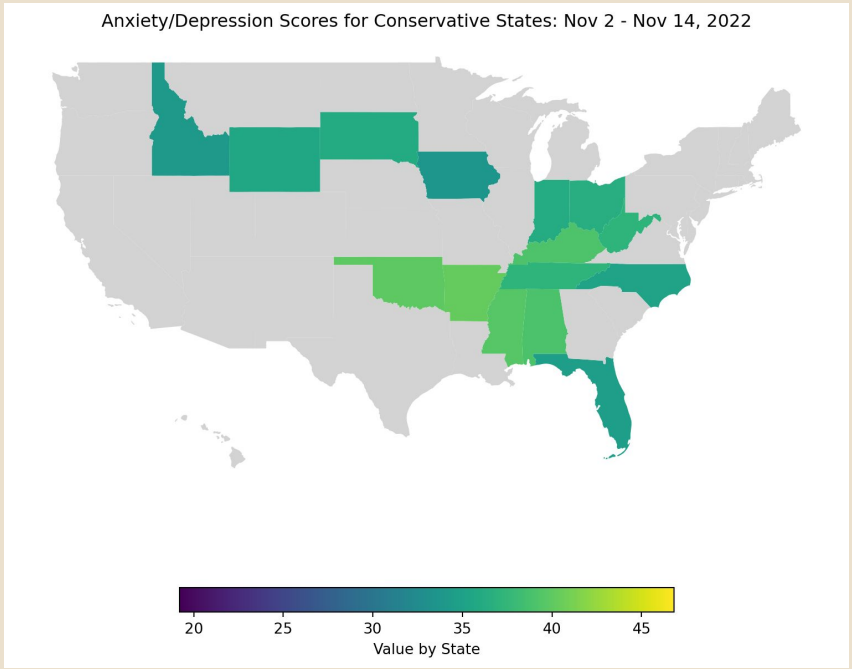
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

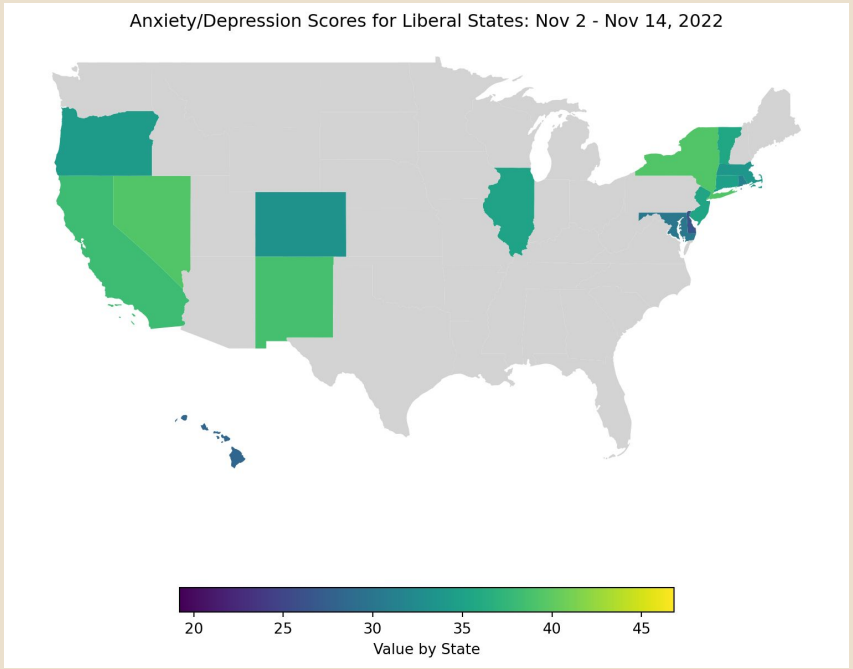




Oct 5 - Oct 17, 2022

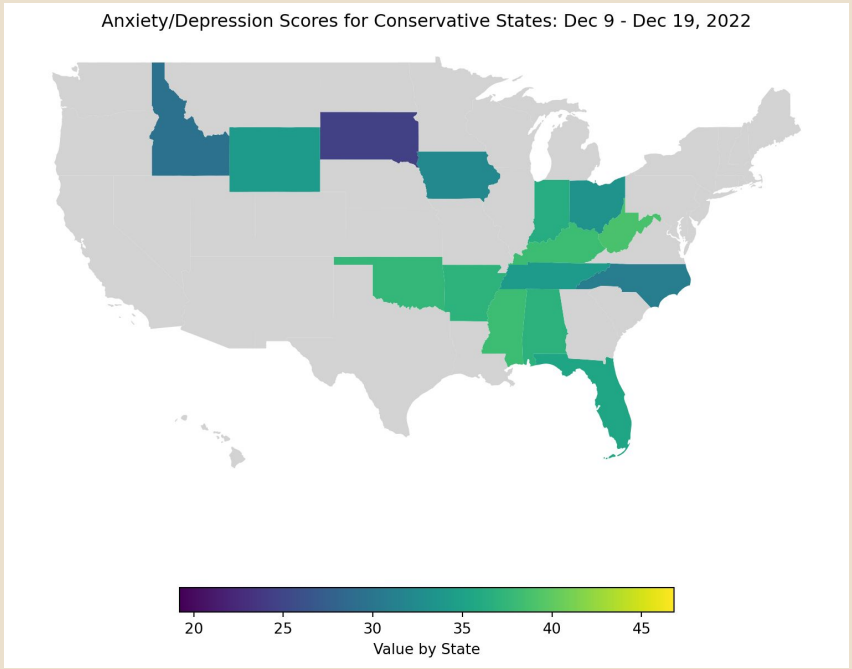
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

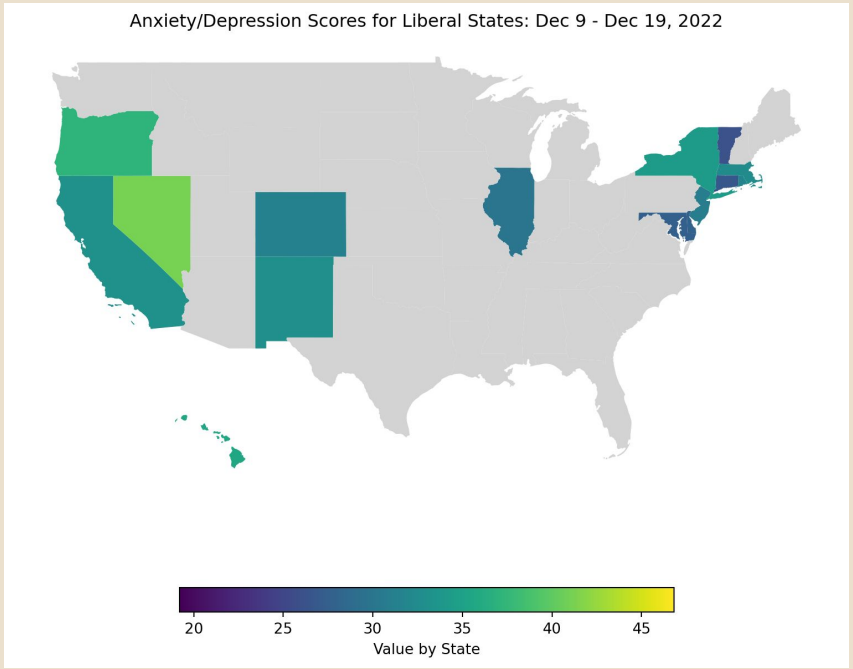




Nov 2 - Nov 14, 2022

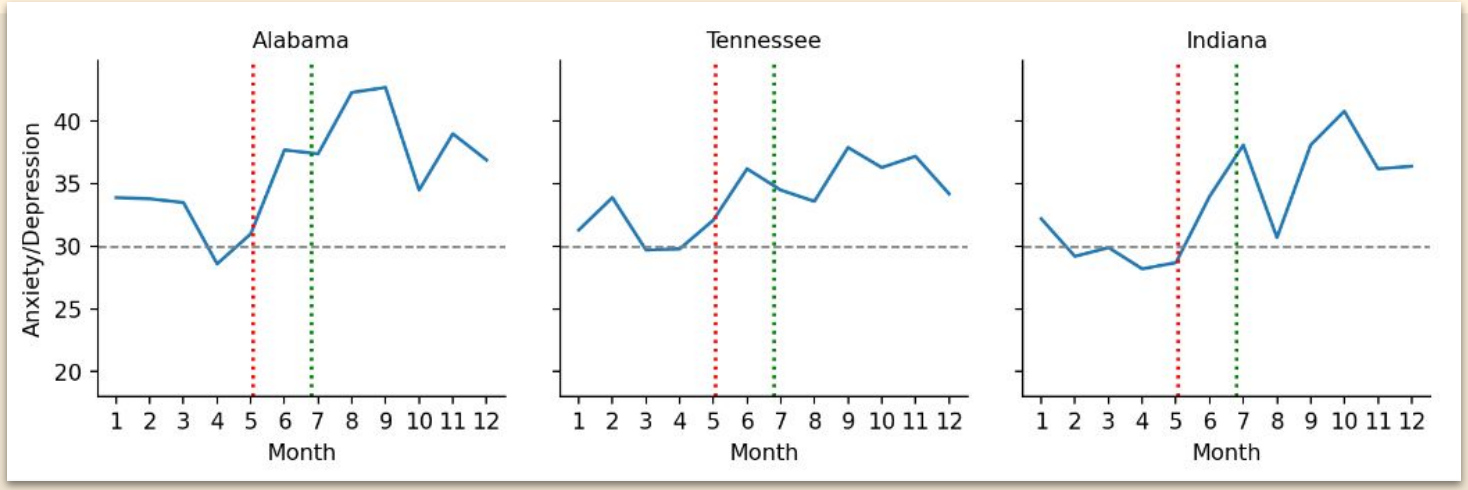
Anxiety & Depression, 2022

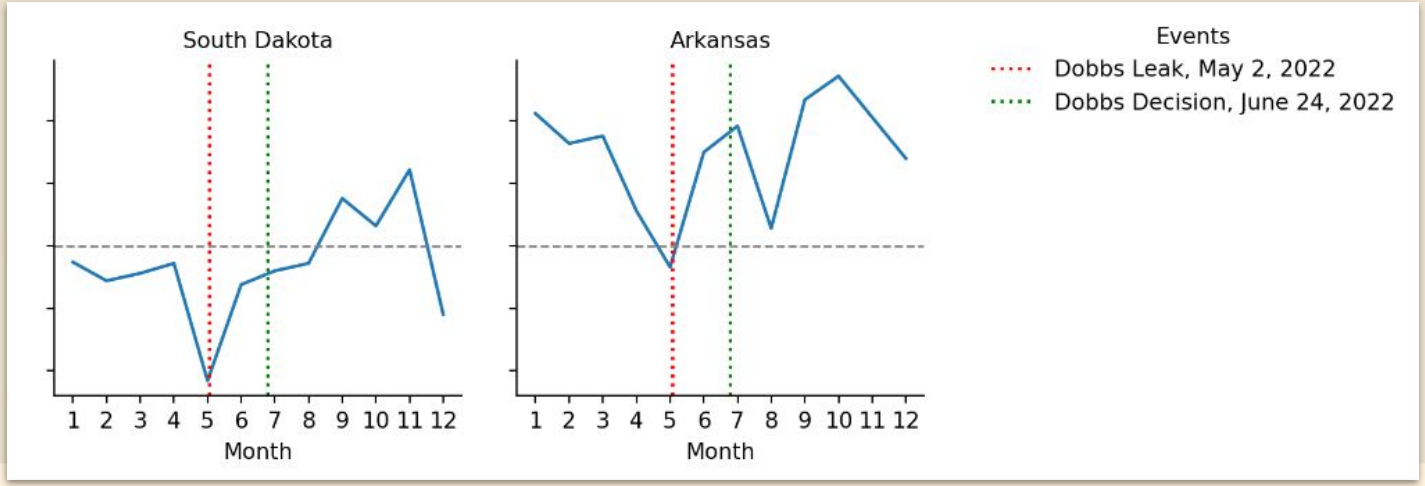




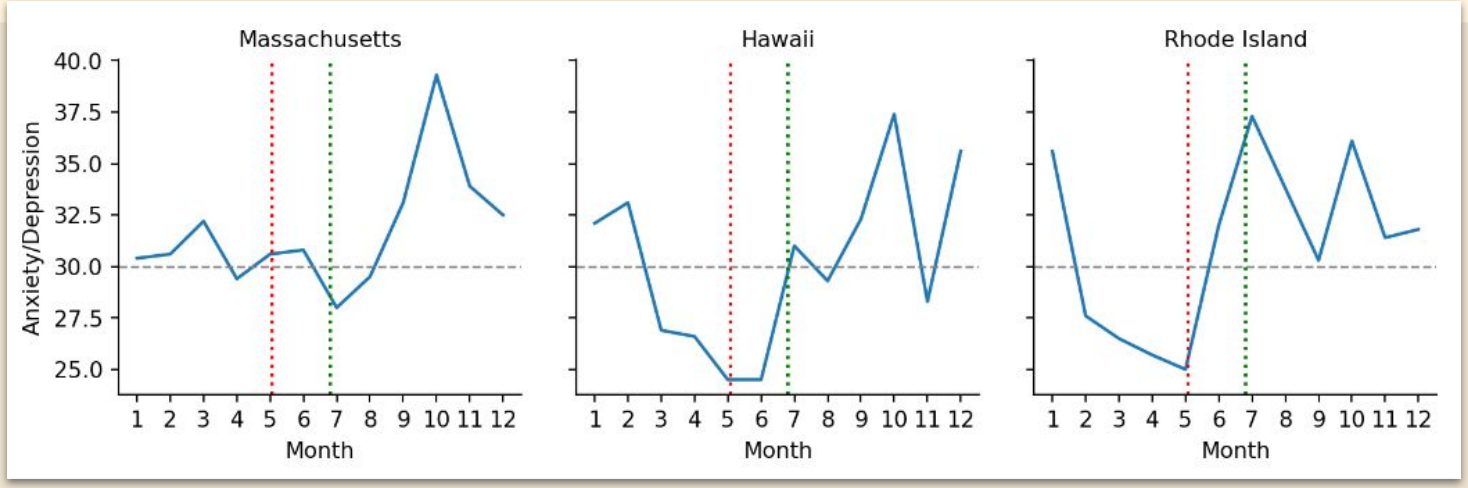
Dec 9 - Dec 19, 2022

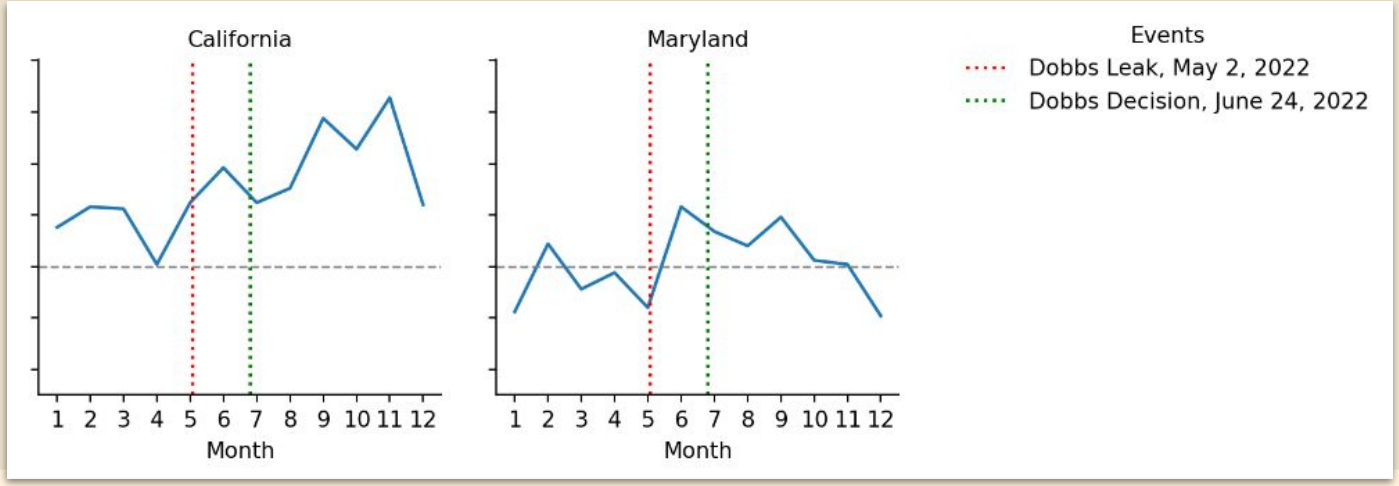
Conservative states

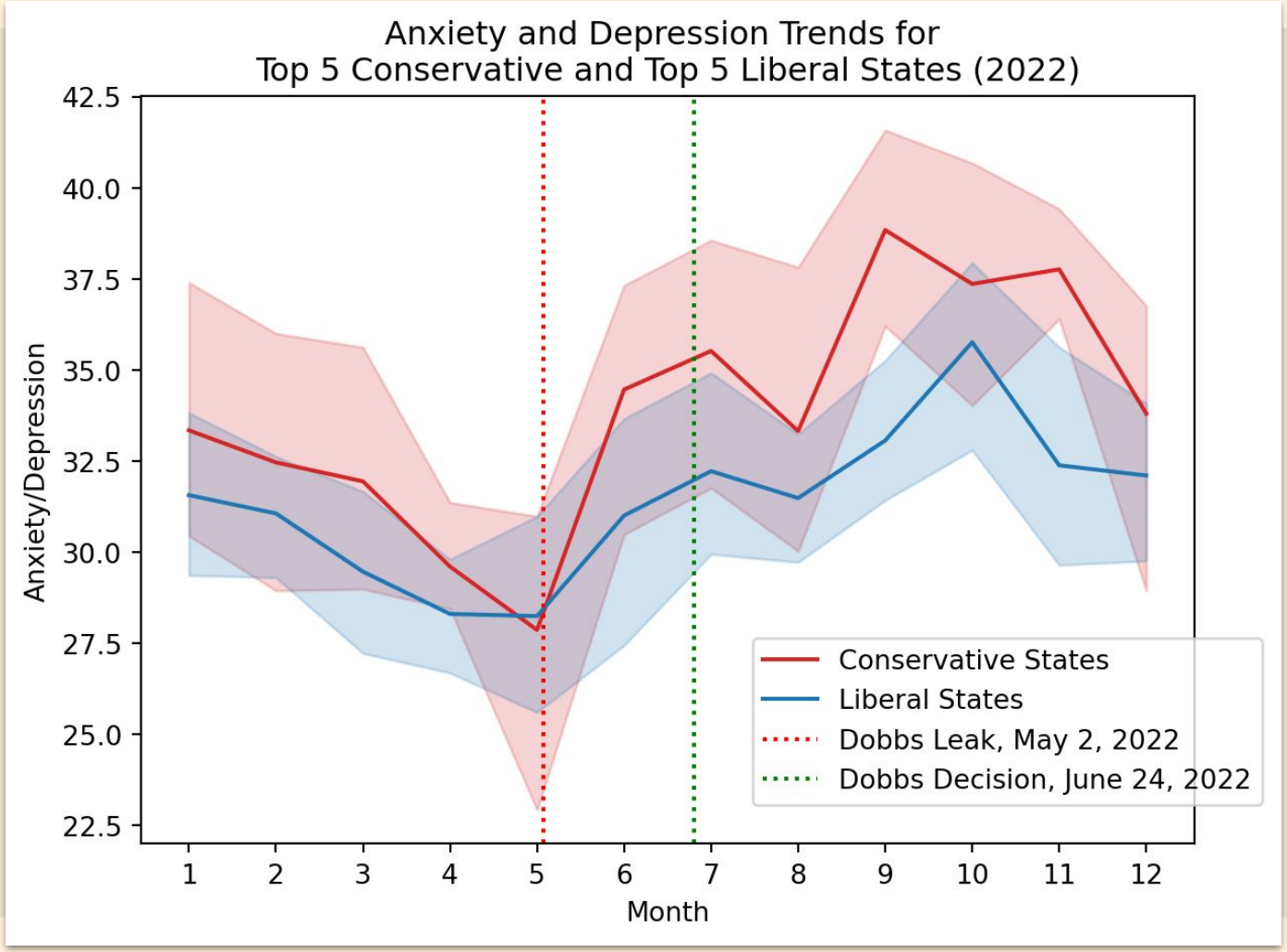


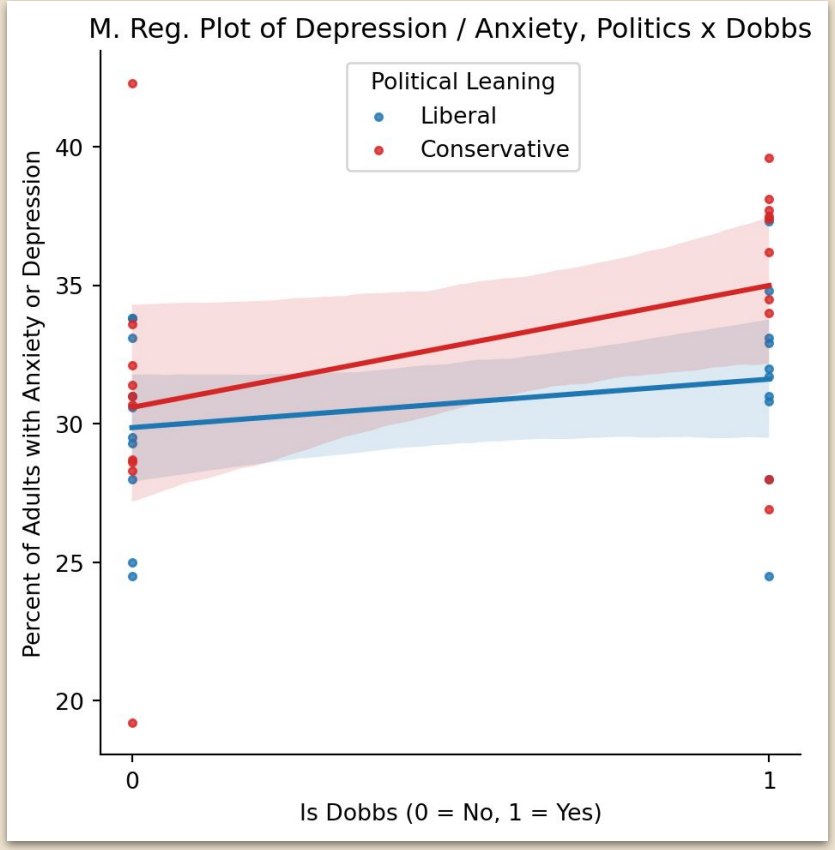


Liberal states






Anxiety and Depression Trends for
Top 5 Conservative and Top 5 Liberal States (2022)
Anxiety/Depression
42.5
40.0
37.5
35.0
32.5
30.0
27.5
25.0
22.5
1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
Month
Conservative States
Liberal States
Dobbs Leak, May 2, 2022
Dobbs Decision, June 24, 2022



Independent Samples t-Test

Variable	Group	*M*	*SD*
Anxiety / Depression Score	Conservative	33.85	4.96
	Liberal	31.38	3.38

Test	*t*	*df*	*p*
Independent Samples t-Test	3.16	118	0.002

Given the *p* value, we reject the null hypothesis. There is a statistically significant difference in means.

Our analysis shows a **clear difference** in anxiety and depressive symptoms between populations of conservative and liberal states.

Thank you!